MAPLE-CHAGA MUFFINS
WITH SASKATOON BERRIES

makes 12 muffins

Chaga is traditionally made into a tea (see Fireweed and Chaga Tea, page 369) or burned for incense. In small amounts, its natural vanilla-like flavor can also complement baked goods, such as these muffins made of wild rice and cassava flour. Wild rice grows sporadically in the Northern Forests. While cassava is not a regional ingredient, people all over Turtle Island have traditionally made flours out of wild root vegetables. Cassava flour is one common root vegetable–based flour that's easy to access, so I call for that here.

- 3 tablespoons sunflower oil, plus more for the muffin tin
- ¾ cup wild rice flour (see Note)
- ¼ cup cassava flour
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- 1 tablespoon chaga powder
- ¾ teaspoon fine sea salt
- 1 duck egg
- ¾ cup maple syrup
- ½ cup wild rice milk (see Seed, Nut, and Grain Milks, page 35) or other nondairy milk
- 2 cups saskatoon berries or blueberries, fresh or frozen

Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line 12 cups of a standard muffin tin with paper liners or lightly grease the wells with a little oil.

In a medium bowl, whisk together the wild rice flour, cassava flour, baking soda, chaga powder, and salt.

In a second bowl, using a whisk, lightly beat the egg, then whisk in the maple syrup, the 3 tablespoons oil, the wild rice milk, and ¼ cup water. Stir the flour mixture into the milk mixture until well incorporated to form a thin batter. Fold in 1 cup of the berries.

Fill each muffin cup so it's about two-thirds full (or about 5 tablespoons of batter per cup). Divide the remaining 1 cup of berries among the muffins.

Bake for about 18 minutes, or until a tester inserted in the center comes out clean and the muffins spring back when you touch them.

Transfer the muffin tin to a rack to cool for a few minutes before lifting the muffins out of the pan to serve.

Note: *While you can purchase wild rice flour, you can also make your own. Place 1 cup wild rice in a food processor or a high-powered blender and pulse to finely chop. Then let the machine run until the rice is ground to a flour-like consistency. Sift the wild rice flour through a fine-mesh sieve to remove any large pieces before using. Refrigerate or freeze the flour for up to 1 month.*